

GLOSSARY

AESIR one of the two tribes of Norse gods and goddesses

ALFHEIM one of the nine realms – home of the light elves and ruled by the god Freyr

ALL-FATHER another name for Odin

ASGARD “enclosure of the Aesir” – one of the nine realms and fortified home of the gods

BIFROST magical bridge connecting Asgard to Midgard

BRISINGAMEN bright and beautiful necklace owned by the goddess Freya

COSMOS the nine realms of Norse mythology – connected by Yggdrasil, the World Tree

DISIR magical spirits who control fate and destiny

DRAUPNIR magical golden ring made by the dwarfs Brokkr and Eitri that was given to Odin

DWARES race of people – expert miners and metalworkers; not necessarily short

EDDAS two historical manuscripts compiled by the Icelandic skald Snorri Sturluson

EINHERJAR Norse warriors chosen to live in Valhalla after a brave death in battle

ELF magical and demi-god-like creatures who live in Alfheim

FATE future or destiny of gods and mortals

FERTILITY ability to create life – fertile fields yield crops and fertile animals create offspring

FIMBULVETR terrible winter that will last three years and heralds the beginning of Ragnarök

FÓLKVANGR meadow ruled by the goddess Freya, where half the warriors slain in battle go to live

FUTHARK writing system used by the Norse – the runes were carved into wood and stone

FYLGIA supernatural spirit that guides people towards their fate – often takes animal form

GIANTS race of people – dangerous, constant enemy of the gods; not necessarily big

GINNUNGAGAP void that existed before the nine realms were created

GJALLARHORN mighty horn that Heimdall will blow before battle commences at Ragnarök

GJÖLL one of eleven rivers – it separates the land of the living from the land of the dead

GULLINBURSTI “Golden Bristles” – golden boar made by dwarfs Brokkr and Eitri that was given to the god Freyr

GULLTOPPR “golden mane” – horse owned by the god Heimdall

HAMINGIUR female guiding spirit who decides a person’s happiness and success

HEIDRUN great goat in Valhalla that eats from a tree and produces mead for the Einherjar to drink

HILDISVÍNI boar, owned and ridden by the goddess Freya

HIMINBJORG “heaven’s castle” – located near Bifrost, this is Heimdall’s home

HOFUD sword owned and wielded by Heimdall

HUGIN “thought” – one of Odin’s two spying ravens

IMMORTALITY everlasting life

INFERNO fire, flames and destruction

INNANGARD “within the enclosure” – civilized and in a state of order; the opposite of “utangard”

JÁRNGREIPR iron gloves worn by the god Thor – help him throw his hammer, Mjöltnir

JOTUNHEIM one of the nine realms – the land of the giants

LANDVAETTIR protective spirits of the land – they can live in trees, rocks and forests